

EXECUTIVE BRIEF

Housing Need Beyond Counts

What leaders should authorize, require, and refuse

Production Unit	PU-B07-C51
Decision status	Controlled learning asset
Audience	Executives, programme owners, statisticians, technical leads
Data	Synthetic examples only

Executive takeaway: Assess housing need through households, adequacy, affordability, location, tenure context, supply, displacement risk, and uncertainty—not dwelling counts alone.

Why it matters

Unit counts can conceal unaffordability, overcrowding, poor quality, exclusion, and housing that is disconnected from livelihoods and services.

Illustrative application

A city compares household formation, rents, incomes, vacancies, housing quality, and location before defining an intervention.

Minimum approval conditions

- Named accountable owner and lawful purpose
- Defined evidence, provenance, reference period, population, and geography
- Decision-relevant validation and visible uncertainty
- Documented abstention, referral, override, and incident processes
- Accessibility, equity, security, retention, and retirement review

Non-negotiable boundary

The analytical system may inform review. It may not independently authorize benefits, sanctions, enforcement, clinical treatment, school exclusion, displacement, or another consequential action.